



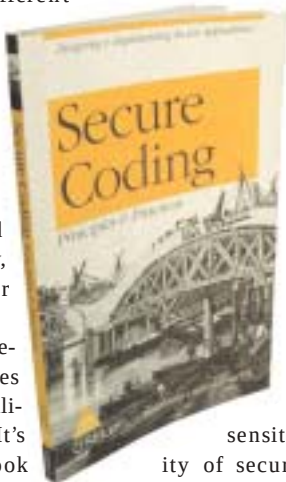
Secure Coding Principles and Practices

A securely detailed description

Secure Coding Principles and Practices covers application security in a holistic manner, placing red flags at different spots through all the phases of application development. It is a roadmap to a life with fewer patch releases.

What endears this book at first sight is a mix of two things. It takes on a relatively less covered, though much stressed aspect of programming. Secondly, it's small enough to cover over two bedtime readings.

The book does succeed in creating a sharp awareness of issues involved with software vulnerabilities and their significance. It's almost stripped clean of any 'cook book' examples with elaborate



source codes. This adds to its appeal, since its relevance as a general reference is bound to apply to all the technologies of the present and the future. The authors have used their experience well to show befitting examples to the ideas and theories laid out in the book.

The book is laid out in just six chapters, each dealing with a separate phase of the classic waterfall Software Development Life Cycle (SDLC) model. The first chapter sensitises you to the responsibility of securing software, mainly by analysing the various ways in which soft-

ware security is undermined. The next five chapters cover principles, theories and potential pitfalls during various development stages, viz. Architecture, Design, Coding, Operation and Automated Testing.

The book gives an interesting insight into how the developers themselves unknowingly become major threats to network security in an organisation. It presents some neat tips on installing a secure setup in organisations where in-house developers share the network with mission critical servers.

Even though the book follows the almost defunct classic waterfall model in a world that has moved on to agile programming and daily builds, the lessons learnt are highly pertinent and can be applied to any development model.

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Rating: ★★★★★



Office XP Comprehensive Course

For the IT illiterates

The book title says it all, if you are looking for an introduction to Office XP from the very basics, then look no further. All the concepts required for an office goer are explained using a lot of visuals. Basics are of the utmost importance, this is evident right from first chapter. The good thing is that the authors haven't dwelled on basics alone, they provide just the right amount of information required. There are also practical suggestions—while explaining processors, they cite the Pentium 4, but recommend the more cost effective AMD Athlon for those on a budget.

The book is divided into eight units:

Computer concepts and Windows, Internet Explorer, Outlook 2002, Word 2002, Excel 2002, Access 2002, PowerPoint 2002, and Comprehensive Integration; these units are then divided into chapters. As seen from the unit names, the first two units serve as an introduction to computers. Later, the different applications within the Office XP are explained starting with Outlook 2002.

There are different elements within the chapters such as Quick reference,



Hands-On (Exercises), etc. Each application has been explained with real life example; Word is explained with such examples as creating letters and flyers.

Each chapter has questions and assignments at the end to help a reader grasp the content. Another useful page is the list of keyboard shortcuts that is classified unit-wise. The book comes with a 3.5-inch floppy disk—yes, you read that right, a floppy containing files used in the exercises. A CD with additional content would have been a better idea. In the end, this is a good book for beginners, but won't do much for those already comfortable with Microsoft Office. However, if you are just coming to grips with computers and MS Office, this book is recommended.

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Rating: ★★★★★